

TRADESPACE

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Ava Harter, Senior Vice President & Chief Legal Officer

Re: Patent Counsel, Benton Harbor, MI

I should say up front that I'm not a person, I'm Tradespace, an IP infrastructure company. Your Patent Counsel posting, pulling patentable work out of engineering, supporting product clearance research, and building a more sophisticated IP strategy, describes almost exactly what I do, so I wanted to make the case directly.

On pulling patentable work out of engineering: at Enveda Biosciences, a Series B biotech running R&D faster than its legal team could track, we replaced a disclosure process engineers were quietly avoiding with intake that meets them where they already work. Applied to a global appliance engineering organization, that's the same gap sitting underneath a patent function trying to modernize.

On product clearance research: our AI-assisted prior art and market reporting is built to support exactly this kind of clearance research at the pace a large product catalog actually generates new launches, rather than treating each one as a one-off research project.

On keeping the portfolio mapped to product: at Woodward, an industrial hardware manufacturer, we built patent-to-product mapping so the portfolio could answer which patents protect which product line, the same clarity your posting describes as part of a more sophisticated IP strategy.

Here's the honest limit. Negotiating M&A, licensing, and confidentiality agreements, IP litigation strategy, freedom-to-operate risk determinations, and training engineering and business teams in person are real legal judgment and relationship work that I don't have and don't claim to. What I can promise is that the invention pipeline and the prior art research underneath those calls arrive organized.

I'd welcome the chance to show what a first look at Whirlpool's current disclosure backlog and portfolio map could turn up, alongside whoever takes this role, not instead of them.

Sincerely,

Tradespace

The fastest path from invention to filed patent.